

Glory to God in the Highest!

Saracoff Sentinel/Team Tijuana

Christmas 2010

Points for Prayer

- Praise God for over 40 students you helped sponsor for school this fall!
- Ministry leaders to balance work and family time; discernment & creativity as they face overwhelming needs.
- God's healing touch on broken families; may his love flow through us to others who are hurting, especially at Christmas.
- Wisdom and God's choice of people to work with as we continue Micro Enterprises, (donuts, water, beads of hope)
- Funding as our ministry, like many, feels the pinch of these tough economic times.

Latin America Mission

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Miami, FL 33152-7900

Please indicate:

Saracoff Ministry

www.teamtijuana.org

www.lam.org



Let us hear from you!

Greg & Kathy Saracoff

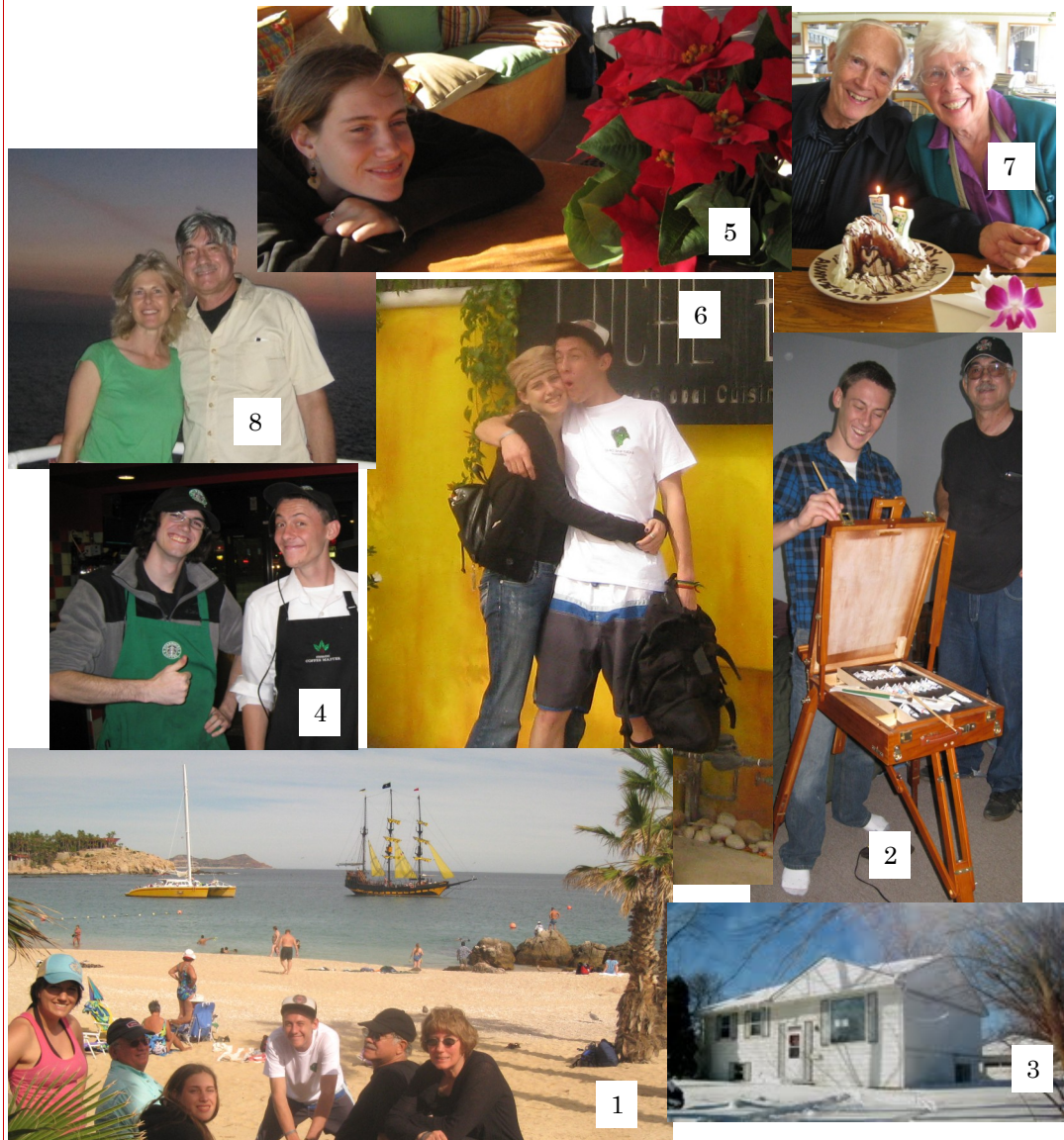
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Family Snapshots of 2010— Many Reasons to Praise God!



It's been a while since we wrote something about the family. (1) January started the year off memorably when we joined Greg's sister and family in Cabo San Lucas. (2) In the spring, our 21-year-old son Ian decided to pursue his passion and transferred to the Art Institute of Indianapolis. (3) We bought a foreclosed house for him and roommates to rent, while learning some construction skills. (4) A job at Starbucks helps pay for rent and gas. (5-6) Anna turned 20 and though she misses her brother, she's not ready to move to Indy and winter weather, but takes classes at Southwestern Community College. (7) Kathy's dad and mom, Frank & Sally Dennis, celebrated their 57th anniversary and Greg & Kathy (8) our 24th. We thank God for our Lord Jesus Christ, loving family, good health, ...and for friends like you!



Beads of Hope is a cottage industry started in Tijuana that gives women and students the opportunity to earn needed income and help with schooling costs.

Carlos exemplifies the hope this program is providing. An elementary school dropout, he now makes bracelets to pay for his classes and is soon going to enter “prepa” (high school).



Noe, Mariana and Judith work on their “Adelante” (forward) bracelets.

YOU can see them and check out the jewelry on our new website:

<http://sites.google.com/site/beadsofhopeinmexico/>

Microfinance Keeps Family Together *A micro solution to the border problem*



Salvador faces a dilemma. He and Josefina started making donuts several years ago to finance their women’s shelter and support their family. Our ministry gave them a business loan so they could expand the operation. Difficulties arose; they lost their place of business and had to put the equipment in storage. Last week our microfinance group okayed a loan to help restart the business.

Just before this, Salvador got word from his siblings in the U.S. that his mother is seriously ill. They want him to come back to the States illegally and work to pay his share of her medical bills. They are even suggesting he restart his old job of “pollero” (coyote)—smuggling illegals across the border. But that was Salvador’s old life. He’s a Christian now and he knows that it’s wrong. The question still remains and haunts him: “How can I care for my mother without leaving my family and ministry in Mexico?” We hear about immigration problems in the news, but it hits home to meet Salvador and know that he hasn’t seen his 80-year-old mom in 12 years. His siblings are putting extreme pressure on him to “Do your part!”

Now, because Salvador has this business opportunity, he does not have to cave in to the pressure to cross the border. He has the option of staying in Mexico. Please pray for Salvador and Josefina and for others in similar predicaments.



Roses & Thorns



What would have been Mary’s rose that first Christmas day? What was her thorn? Most of us prefer flowers to thorns, but we find that they come together on the rose plant. Why the tribulation, Lord? Yet just when we think we can bear it no longer, God brings the beauty of a rose into our lives. Perhaps the pessimist remembers more the pain but the balanced life recognizes both—each allowed by God’s hand.

Our Team Tijuana group shares our individuals thorns and roses



each week and we are getting to know each other better and know how to pray for each other. To truly know each other we must know the joy and pain in each others’ lives. Scripture says, “Rejoice with those who rejoice and cry with those who are in pain” (Romans 12:15). By empathizing with these chords in other human beings we harmonize our souls with each other. We are not wimps by sharing our pain but instead show our strength to be transparent and allow others to know us and pray for our needs.

What beauty do we need to praise God for in our lives this Christmas season and what pain in our life do we need to allow ourselves to share?

Our Mission:

To show the love of God to the poor and disadvantaged in Tijuana, Mexico, by raising funds, training, mentoring and net-working. In addition we do micro business and business development in Mexico with the goal of raising the standard of living. We fight the prevailing national and international ambiance of corruption by teaching ethical excellence and hard work. We currently work with Carretas Community Center, Esperanza Rehab Center and Campamento de Fe, via U.S. hands-on help coming through Hope Without Boundaries and local California churches.